Build a 16-week interview prep syllabus — weekly STAR drills, mock interview milestones, and career center tool integrations

Computer
Turn STAR behavioral practice into a 16-week grading rubric and student workbook — weekly milestones, story banks, and mock rubrics
Computer
Add week-by-week weekly assignments
Include specific Big Interview module steps
Detail the Handshake mock interview milestones
Outline and Detail Also how Semester intlgense can and should provide recomendations on clubs classes actvities comunties and such to join based of intrests and the users inputed data

Semester should combine a **16-week** interview curriculum with an interest-to-opportunity recommendation system: students practice explaining their existing experiences while discovering classes, clubs, activities, and communities that genuinely fit their goals—not merely things that "look good on a résumé."

I created two companion artifacts: a student workbook with reusable story-bank, mock-review, evidence, and recommendation worksheets, and a weekly-assignment CSV.

The specification below adds concrete Big Interview steps, Handshake appointment milestones, weekly grading, and recommendation-system behavior. It remains a proposed curriculum and product specification; it does not establish that Semester has deployed these features or has authorized integrations with either vendor.

1. How the three systems should work together

System	Primary responsibility
Semester	Curriculum, weekly assignments, story bank, evidence links, practice feedback, student-controlled plans, and progress
Big Interview	Licensed learning modules, answer-building tools, practice sets, and instructor assignments
Handshake	Institution-provided career resources and career-center appointment scheduling, where enabled
Career staff	Human coaching, specialist feedback, contested assessments, and institution-approved grading decisions

Big Interview's current help documentation lists Fast Track, Mastery Track, Interview Playbooks, Written Curriculum, Resume Curriculum, and other learning tracks. Its

documented entry path is Learn → Interview Curriculum → choose a module. [1]

Handshake is not inherently the mock-interview simulator in this design. It provides a way to request a career-center appointment when the school enables appointment scheduling; mock interviews are an appointment type the institution can configure. [2] [3]

Semester should preserve these distinctions. Booking an appointment does not prove attendance, completing a module does not prove mastery, and uploading an artifact does not automatically verify a skill.

2. Weekly syllabus and assignments

Standard weekly workload

Proposed default: approximately two hours, adjustable for institutional credit requirements and student needs.

- Learn: 20–30 minutes.
- Draft or research: 20–30 minutes.
- Practice and retry: 30–40 minutes.
- Reflect and submit: 10–20 minutes.
- Human-mock weeks: replace some individual practice with the appointment.

Each week has one primary submission. Avoid making students upload the same work separately to Semester, Big Interview, and a learning management system unless an institutional requirement makes that necessary.

Weeks 1–4: establish a baseline and build STAR foundations

Week	Assignment and STAR drill	Big Interview steps	Submission
1 — Baseline	Answer “Tell me about yourself” and “Tell me about a time you worked on a team.” Do not polish the baseline. Write two goals and a short reflection.	Open Learn → Interview Curriculum → Fast Track. Start Interview Fundamentals where available. Open a General practice set and answer two questions.	Baseline responses, reflection, two goals
2 — Read the opportunity	Annotate one posting. Separate responsibilities, required qualifications, preferences, and unknowns. Draft one STAR story that addresses a real requirement.	Open Written Curriculum → Module 5: Interview Prep. Use the relevant preparation lessons.	Requirement map and story 1
3 — Inventory experiences	List eight experiences from classes, work, research, clubs, volunteering, or independent projects. Draft teamwork and problem-solving stories.	Open Answer Builder. Start a behavioral response, enter a genuine experience, and save as you progress.	Experience inventory and stories 2–3
4 — STAR structure	Draft conflict and initiative stories. Label Situation, Task, Action, and Result. Practice one answer, inspect feedback, and retry.	Open Written Curriculum → Module 9: Behavioral Interview Questions. Use Answer Builder to revise the selected story.	Stories 4–5 and before/after response

The Written Curriculum module names above are documented by Big Interview. Answer Builder's build, save, edit, and export workflow is described in the university quick-start guide. Exact navigation can differ by interface and institutional configuration. [4] [1]

Weeks 5–8: deepen personal contribution and connect evidence

Week	Assignment and STAR drill	Big Interview steps	Submission
5 — Individual action	Revise three stories to distinguish "we" from "I." For each, answer: "What did you personally own?" and "Why did you choose that approach?"	Select behavioral questions from the available practice tools. Record or otherwise practice one revised answer and review it.	Three revisions and follow-up answers
6 — Results and learning	Draft setback and adaptability stories. Audit all numerical claims. Explain qualitative outcomes when no defensible metric exists.	Continue the relevant behavioral lessons in Written Curriculum or Mastery Track. Use Answer Builder to revise results.	Stories 6–7 and claim audit
7 — Résumé and portfolio	Create a targeted résumé. Link three permitted artifacts. Explain individual contribution, team attribution, and confidentiality restrictions. Practice explaining one résumé bullet as STAR.	Open Learn → Interview Curriculum → Resume Curriculum. Use résumé-building functionality only if included in the institution's access.	Résumé v1, portfolio v1, one linked STAR response
8 — Human mock I	Complete a supported behavioral mock. Choose two improvement goals and retry two questions.	Review relevant Fast Track lessons and rehearse selected General questions before the appointment.	Coach rubric, reflection, two retries

Resume Curriculum appears in Big Interview's current curriculum documentation. Its student guide describes résumé-building functionality as conditional on availability. [5] [1]

Weeks 9–12: broaden stories and handle unfamiliar questions

Week	Assignment and STAR drill	Big Interview steps	Submission
9 — Story range	Add leadership and prioritization stories. Map which questions each story genuinely addresses. Avoid forcing one favorite story into every answer.	Use Question Library or available practice sets to find questions across the assigned categories.	Stories 8–9 and coverage map
10 — Employer research	Create a source-backed employer briefing. Draft "why this role," "why this organization," and three questions to ask. Retry one role-relevant STAR answer.	Open Fast Track → Closing the Deal or Mastery Track → Acing Common Interview Questions for interviewer-question guidance.	Briefing, motivation answer, three questions
11 — Discipline practice	Complete two technical, case, research, teaching, or portfolio exercises. Explain a project decision using STAR where appropriate.	Choose an applicable practice set or Interview Playbook, subject to actual availability.	Specialist exercise and project explanation
12 — Follow-ups	Practice three unscripted follow-ups. Clarify an ambiguous question, explain a tradeoff, and acknowledge a limitation. Complete mock II with a coach or approved reviewer.	Use Interview Roulette if available, or select unfamiliar questions from the question library.	Follow-up log, mock II rubric, improvement plan

Big Interview documents interviewer-question guidance in Closing the Deal and Acing Common Interview Questions, and provides specialist Interview Playbooks. University

guidance also identifies Question Library and Interview Roulette as available practice tools, although tenant interfaces may differ. [6] [1]

Weeks 13–16: integrate and rehearse

Week	Assignment and STAR drill	Big Interview steps	Submission
13 — Full simulation	Complete six questions with follow-ups. Include introduction, motivation, two behavioral questions, one track-specific question, and student questions. Revise two answers afterward.	Complete an instructor-created assignment if available; otherwise use a suitable practice set.	Full simulation and two retries
14 — Formats and logistics	Rehearse the likely interview format. Complete a technology, time-zone, location, and accessibility checklist. Deliver one STAR response in that format.	Select relevant format lessons or Interview Playbooks. Review saved responses for content clarity.	Logistics checklist and format rehearsal
15 — Human mock III	Complete a final role-specific mock. Check résumé–story consistency. Draft, but do not automatically send, a follow-up message.	Review relevant lessons and practice the two weakest question categories before the appointment.	Final rubric, consistency audit, follow-up draft
16 — Capstone	Submit the final preparation packet. Compare baseline and final responses. Identify remaining gaps and a realistic next-month plan.	Review permitted saved work or completion evidence. Use First 90 Days Curriculum optionally for a student transitioning into a role.	Final packet and reflection

Big Interview supports instructor-coded interview assignments and saved-response review; First 90 Days Curriculum is also listed in its learning catalog. [1] [5]

Weekly assignment policy

Students should be able to:

- Choose a different genuine experience.
- Avoid disclosing sensitive or confidential details.
- Use a text or live accessible alternative when recording is unsuitable.
- Revise after formative feedback.
- Challenge feedback without being penalized.
- Receive an alternative when a licensed tool or appointment is unavailable.

Interview preparation should not reward prestige, access to internships, or willingness to disclose private experiences.

3. Specific Big Interview operating instructions

A. Learning-module sequence

Use this documented entry point:

1. Sign into the institution-provided account.
2. Select Learn.
3. Select Interview Curriculum.
4. Choose the assigned track or module.
5. Complete the selected lessons and available quizzes or practice questions.
6. Record completion using the institution's approved method.[1]

Recommended mapping:

- Weeks 1 and 8: Fast Track.
- Weeks 2 and 10: Interview Prep and common-question guidance.
- Weeks 4–6 and 9: Behavioral Interview Questions and deeper practice.
- Week 7: Resume Curriculum.
- Weeks 11 and 14: relevant Interview Playbooks.
- Week 16: optional First 90 Days Curriculum.

This is Semester's proposed assignment mapping, not an official Big Interview 16-week course.

B. Answer Builder sequence

Where Answer Builder is available:

1. Open Practice → Answer Builder.
2. Under Build an Answer, choose Start.
3. Select the response type.
4. Enter the student's real situation and response.
5. Save while progressing.
6. Review the saved answer under My Answers.
7. Edit or export it for an approved reviewer if needed.[4]

Semester should retain a student-approved story record—not automatically ingest every answer from the vendor.

C. Practice-set sequence

1. Open the available Practice Interviews or Practice Sets area.
2. Start with a General set such as Top 10 Questions or Entry Level where available.
3. Select an appropriate difficulty.
4. Listen to or read the question.

5. Respond.
6. Save the response before moving on.
7. Review and retry selected answers. [5] [6]

Difficulty is a student-controlled practice setting, not a grading category.

D. Instructor assignment sequence

1. Open Interview Assignments or the tenant's Assignments tab.
2. Enter the instructor-provided code.
3. Inspect time and attempt limits before beginning.
4. Answer and save each question.
5. Review the responses before submission.
6. Submit when ready.
7. Review instructor feedback in the submitted-assignment area. [5]

Do not invent assignment codes or assume a particular retry limit. The institution must verify its settings and establish accommodation and technical-failure procedures.

Big Interview describes feedback on eye contact, filler words, tone, and other delivery characteristics. Semester should not import those measures into its STAR content grade or treat them as evidence of personality, honesty, disability, or employability. [5]

4. Handshake mock-interview milestones

Milestone schedule

Week	Student action	Preparation shared, with permission	Evidence of completion
2	Check Career Center access and available appointment types; request an initial planning or résumé appointment if needed	Goals and selected opportunity	Request or confirmation, not attendance
6	Request mock I for week 8	Résumé draft, target posting, two goals	Confirmed appointment or alternative support plan
8	Attend mock I	Selected stories and evidence	Coach-approved rubric or student reflection
10	Request mock II for week 12	Updated résumé and identified gaps	Confirmed appointment
12	Complete mock II	Role briefing and follow-up goals	Review and revised preparation plan
13	Request final mock for week 15	Final target role and weak categories	Confirmed appointment
15	Complete final mock	Preparation packet	Final review and student next steps

These are proposed curriculum milestones. Availability depends on institutional staffing and appointment configuration.

Documented desktop booking steps

1. Open Career Center in Handshake's left navigation.
2. Select Appointments under the school's name.
3. Select Schedule a New Appointment.
4. Choose a category and appointment type.
5. Select a date and time.
6. Choose the appointment medium.
7. Explain the request in "What can we help you with?"
8. Select Request and monitor status notifications.[2]

Suggested request:

> "I am preparing for a research-assistant interview. I would like a behavioral mock focused on explaining my individual contribution and discussing a setback. I can share my résumé and selected project summaries."

Missing access or no appointments

Semester should show the actual condition:

- School connection pending.
- Appointment scheduling not enabled.
- Mock-interview type unavailable.
- No suitable appointment times.
- Student-selected alternative needed.

Handshake's documentation identifies school-linkage and school-participation issues as reasons Career Center access may be missing. It also directs students to contact their Career Center when appointment types are unclear.[2]

Fallbacks may include an institution-approved coach, workshop, peer reviewer, or live accessible practice session. Do not mark a student incomplete solely because the institution lacks appointment capacity.

5. Weekly grading and mock-interview rubrics

A. Routine weekly assignment rubric

Use a proposed 10-point rubric for non-mock assignments:

Criterion	Points	Full-credit behavior
Required work	2	Completes the assigned artifact or approved equivalent
Specificity	2	Uses concrete personal actions and relevant details
Accuracy and attribution	2	Distinguishes personal contribution, team work, and unsupported claims
Revision	2	Makes a meaningful improvement or explains why feedback was rejected
Reflection	2	Identifies learning, uncertainty, and a useful next action

Do not grade story quantity alone. An honest, well-developed story is better than several fabricated or repetitive ones.

B. Mock-interview STAR rubric

Apply this to behavioral responses, not every question type.

Dimension	Weight	Strong evidence
Situation	10%	Clear, relevant context
Task	10%	Specific responsibility or goal
Action	30%	Personal steps and reasoning
Result	20%	Observable outcome with limitations and appropriate attribution
Relevance	15%	Direct response to the question
Reflection	10%	Learning or future improvement
Clarity	5%	Understandable sequence and detail

Score each dimension 0–4:

- 0: no assessable content.
- 1: vague or incomplete.
- 2: partially clear.
- 3: clear and specific.
- 4: clear, specific, and appropriately nuanced.

Use “not assessable” separately when the system cannot evaluate—for example, because transcription failed. Do not convert technical failure into a zero.

These weights are proposed educational choices, not a validated hiring assessment.

C. Whole-mock review

In addition to STAR, the reviewer should comment on:

- Understanding the role.
- Handling follow-up questions.
- Consistency with résumé claims.
- Asking relevant questions.
- Clarifying uncertainty.
- Preparation and logistics.

A human reviewer owns any official grade. AI supplies provisional observations with supporting quotations, uncertainty labels, and a student correction path.

D. Semester grade distribution

Proposed weighting:

- Weekly assignments: 30%.
- Story bank and evidence map: 20%.
- Résumé and portfolio: 15%.
- Mock-interview milestones: 20%.
- Capstone and reflection: 15%.

The grading policy should not include employment outcomes, camera use, eye-contact scores, accent, or employer prestige.

6. Student workbook and story-bank structure

The attached workbook provides reusable forms. Its core records are:

Story record

```
Story ID and title
Situation
Task and personal responsibility
Actions personally taken
Result and limitations
Reflection
Individual versus team contribution
Relevant question categories
Evidence references
Confidentiality restrictions
Student-approved version
```

Evidence map

```
Experience → claim → artifact → résumé bullet → STAR story → practice response
```

Keep verification states distinct:

- Student-reported.
- Artifact-linked.
- Reviewer-assessed.
- Issuer-verified.

Your existing career design distinguishes personal skill claims from evidence artifacts, while the implementation handoff limits employers to approved evidence. This curriculum should preserve those boundaries. [7] [8]

A weak practice response should trigger a practice recommendation. It should not automatically become “you lack this skill” or “you must join this club.”

7. Semester Intelligence recommendations for classes, clubs, activities, and communities

A. What the system should optimize for

Semester should help students find experiences that support their own interests, belonging, learning, enjoyment, and goals.

It should not optimize exclusively for résumé production, engagement time, or institutional recruitment.

The existing design materials already identify course, career-opportunity, mentor, community, and event recommendations as governed algorithms requiring explainability, consent, evaluation, and correction paths. [9]

B. Student-controlled inputs

Ask for optional, editable information:

Input	Examples
Interests	Music, robotics, public policy, outdoor activities
Goals	Meet people, explore a major, build something, prepare for research
Experience preference	Beginner-friendly, leadership, hands-on, social, independent
Capacity	Available hours, commute limits, preferred meeting times
Cost constraints	Free options, equipment costs, transportation
Community preference	Small groups, drop-in events, structured commitments

Input	Examples
Learning goals	Public speaking, coding, writing, project management
Explicitly shared academic context	Declared program, completed prerequisites, planned courses
Feedback	“Not interested,” “too expensive,” “show more beginner options”

Offer a useful discovery experience even if the student supplies only one interest.

Do not require sensitive disclosures. Provide functional accessibility filters without demanding a diagnosis.

C. Candidate sources

Use authorized, source-attributed records:

- Official course catalog and current section schedules.
- Approved student-organization directory.
- Campus events and recreation.
- Research and experiential-learning opportunities.
- Volunteer programs.
- Tutoring, study groups, and learning communities.
- Opt-in mentor directories.
- Career-center opportunities.

Every candidate needs source, freshness, owner, and known constraints. A catalog entry does not prove a course has an open seat; a club directory listing does not prove the club is currently active.

D. Recommendation pipeline

```
Student request and permitted preferences
→ retrieve authorized candidates
→ check known eligibility and hard constraints
→ identify unknown requirements
→ rank by transparent relevance
→ diversify options
→ explain tradeoffs
→ student saves, dismisses, compares, or acts
→ optional reflection and preference update
```

Separate:

- Eligibility: can the student participate?
- Relevance: does it fit their interests?
- Feasibility: can they afford the time, cost, and logistics?
- Exploration: is it a useful adjacent possibility?

Unknown eligibility should produce “check this requirement,” not a false rejection.

E. Explainable ranking

A proposed ranking design combines:

- Explicit interest match.
- Goal relevance.
- Student-selected learning opportunities.
- Schedule fit.
- Cost fit.
- Preferred participation style.
- Source confidence and freshness.
- Diversity of options.
- Commitment burden.

Weights should be configurable and visible. Avoid default boosts for prestigious, expensive, highly selective, or already popular activities.

Do not infer sensitive affiliations from browsing or recommend identity-based communities using guessed religion, sexuality, disability, or other protected traits. Students may explicitly request such communities without that interest being repurposed for unrelated profiling.

F. Recommendation cards

Illustrative card—not a verified campus listing:

> Robotics club introductory workshop
> Why it appears: You selected hands-on building and beginner-friendly activities.
> Commitment: One introductory session; ongoing requirements unknown.
> Cost: Not confirmed.
> Source: Approved organization listing, with last-updated date.
> Next step: View details or ask the organizer.
> Controls: Save · Compare · Not interested · Change preferences

For classes, add:

- Prerequisite status.
- Degree-requirement relevance.
- Section availability.
- Schedule conflicts.
- Estimated workload and its basis.
- Advisor or registrar confirmation needs.

“Recommended class” must never be displayed as “officially required” unless an authoritative requirement establishes that status.

G. Connect recommendations to interview preparation carefully

Use two different pathways:

1. Communication gap
   The student has relevant experience but describes it vaguely. Recommend a focused STAR retry or coaching.
2. Experience-building interest
   The student says they want to try something new or build a particular capability. Recommend optional projects, classes, clubs, or activities.

Example:

> “You said you want more experience explaining technical work. Options include a project presentation, a peer-learning group, or a communication course. You can also practice explaining your current project without adding another commitment.”

AI feedback alone is insufficient evidence that a student lacks a competency.

H. Acting on recommendations

Semester may help a student:

- Save and compare options.
- Add a tentative personal task.
- Draft a question.
- Prepare an advisor discussion.
- Review enrollment or joining steps.

Sending a message, booking an event, joining a group, or enrolling in a class requires the applicable confirmation, permissions, and institutional authority. Official registration also requires eligibility checks, reconciliation, and an authorized enrollment workflow.

8. Integration and activation gates

Capability	Owner	Required evidence before activation
Curriculum and grading	Career education lead	Reviewed assignments, rubric, alternatives, appeal policy
Big Interview connection	Integration owner	Licensed access, tenant-specific navigation verification, permitted data flow
Handshake milestones	Career operations	Actual appointment types, staffing, fallback process
AI STAR feedback	AI lead and career specialists	Quotation-grounded feedback, evaluation results, uncertainty and correction behavior
Portfolio sharing	Security/privacy lead	Storage authorization, scoped access, expiry, revocation tests

Capability	Owner	Required evidence before activation
Campus recommendations	Student experience lead	Authoritative directory coverage, freshness, eligibility handling
Course recommendations	Academic planning owner	Requirement provenance, prerequisite checks, advisor/registrar boundary
Production activation	Institutional implementation lead	Authorization, monitoring, support ownership, rollback and disable controls

Do not assume either vendor permits importing recordings, scores, appointment details, or progress. Begin with approved links and student-attested evidence where necessary; activate deeper synchronization only after contractual and technical verification.

Keep each capability's status separate: designed, implemented, tested, deployed, institution-authorized, and production-enabled.

The first implementation should connect one complete student loop: select an opportunity → build a truthful story → link permitted evidence → practice → review and retry → request human support → explore an optional next experience. That extends Semester's existing career direction without creating another disconnected subsystem.[8] [7]

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1. https://support.biginterview.com/en/article/the-interview-curriculum-learn-av0ifo/
2. https://support.joinhandshake.com/hc/en-us/articles/219133257-Request-an-Appointment-with-your-Career-Center
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